

How to use ClipReframe

ClipReframe turns a 16:9 stream clip (gameplay + webcam) into a 1080×1920 vertical video ready for TikTok and YouTube Shorts. No install: run `ClipReframe-<version>-portable.exe`.

First launch takes ~20 s while the app unpacks itself next to the exe (folder `ClipReframe/`). Later launches are instant. You can delete that folder at any time; it is recreated.

1. Open a clip

- **Drag & drop** a video anywhere onto the window, or click **Browse...**
- Supported: `.mp4`, `.mov`, `.mkv`, `.webm`, `.m4v`. Any resolution works; 16:9 is what the layout is designed for (you get a notice for other aspect ratios).
- Dropping another file while a clip is open **replaces** the clip (a purple "Drop to replace" overlay confirms it). The right-hand panel is excluded from that overlay so you can still drop an outro there.

2. Frame the two rectangles

The centre shows your source; the right shows the vertical result live.

Rectangle	Goes to	Colour
Webcam	top of the vertical	cyan
Gameplay	bottom of the vertical	pink

- Drag inside a rectangle to move it. Drag a handle to resize (the aspect ratio is locked so the crop always fills its band without distortion).
- Click a rectangle to select it; a rule-of-thirds grid appears.
- **Webcam height** slider — or drag the purple line in the preview — changes how much of the vertical frame the webcam gets (20 %–60 %). The rectangles re-fit automatically.
- **Layout** → **Fill** switches to a single 9:16 crop of the gameplay (no webcam band).

Playback: **Space** play/pause · `← / →` ±1 s (**Shift** = ±5 s) · **M** mute · drag the scrub bar.

3. Configurations (presets)

Left sidebar. A configuration stores the layout, both rectangles, the split ratio, the subtitle settings/style and the outro.

- **New** → name it → **Save**: stores the current settings.
- Click a configuration to **apply** it to the current clip.
- ★ marks the **default**: it is applied automatically every time you open a new clip.
- Change something after applying and an **Update "name"** button appears; the row shows a ● while you have unsaved changes.
- 🗑️ deletes (asks for confirmation).

Presets live in `%APPDATA%\ClipReframe\presets.json`; copy that file to move them to another PC.

4. Subtitles (optional)

1. Turn on **Subtitles**.
2. Pick the **spoken language** (French by default; **Auto-detect** also works).
3. Click **Generate subtitles**. Speech recognition runs locally (nothing is uploaded). Expect roughly half the clip's duration on a modern CPU.
4. A clean-up pass removes common recognition artefacts (repeated words, **[Musique]**-style markers, looped phrases) — the toast tells you how many were removed.
5. Edit any cue: text, start/end (seconds). Click into a cue to jump the player there; the active cue is highlighted while playing. The  on a row deletes it.
6. **Style**: font (all installed fonts), size, bold/italic/caps, colour, outline or background box, shadow, position (bottom / centre / top) and margin, max characters per line (auto-wrap). The preview on the right shows the result live.

Subtitles are **burned into** the video (they are part of the picture), which is what TikTok and Shorts need for autoplay-without-sound.

5. Outro / call to action (optional)

Drop a vertical video onto the **Outro** panel or click **Choose outro...** It is appended unchanged after the clip. If it is not 9:16 it is letterboxed, never stretched. Subtitles never appear on the outro. The outro is saved in the configuration, so a "Shorts" preset can carry its own end card.

6. Export

Click **Export**, choose a folder. The file is named `<clip>_vertical.mp4` (the folder is remembered). A progress bar shows speed; **Cancel** stops and removes the partial file. When done the path in the bottom bar opens the folder.

Output: 1080×1920, H.264 High profile, CRF 17 (visually lossless), yuv420p, source frame rate (capped at 60), AAC 192 kbps 48 kHz, **faststart** — accepted as-is by TikTok and YouTube Shorts.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause / fix
Red banner "Missing runtime files"	The ClipReframe/resources/bin folder next to the exe was deleted — relaunch the exe.
Video loads but shows black / won't play	Codec unsupported by Chromium (e.g. some HEVC/10-bit). Re-encode to H.264 first.
"Outro video not found" after applying a preset	The outro file moved. Pick it again.
Subtitles in the wrong language	Set the spoken language before generating; Auto-detect can misfire on short clips.
Exported subtitles look slightly different from the preview	The preview is a CSS approximation of the renderer; sizes and positions match, outline rasterisation differs marginally.